

# Audience Sentiment & Weak Spots: Hormozi, Cardone, Cardone Ventures

## The adversarial angle for Cool Hollow Coaching's "Business Without You"

**Research date:** 2026-06-25

**Angle:** Where Hormozi and Cardone are weak, distrusted, or mismatched to blue-collar owner-operators, and the white space a small proof-led niche player can own.

**Scope:** Real, sourced sentiment and documented facts. Negative claims are confidence-labeled and triangulated where possible. Nothing legally sensitive is stated as proven fact.

**A note on method and its limits.** The dedicated research stack for this job (Reddit client, X/Grok, Firecrawl, Supadata) was not operable this session: Reddit hard-blocked the workspace IP at both the script and fetch layer, and the Firecrawl / xAI / Supadata API keys in `.env` were empty placeholders. All findings below come from open web search and direct page fetches. That means **less raw Reddit/X thread-level sentiment than the brief targeted**, and a heavier lean on review sites, employee-review platforms, court filings, and review/critique articles. Where I could not get a second independent source, the claim is marked accordingly. This is a real gap, called out honestly in the Gaps section, not papered over.

## Executive Summary

The three competitors are not equally vulnerable, and the most useful finding is that **their weaknesses are different in kind**, which means a niche blue-collar player can attack each on a separate front.

- 1. Grant Cardone is the soft target on trust and ethics.** His real-estate fund (Cardone Capital) is the subject of a securities-fraud class action that the **Ninth Circuit revived on June 10, 2025** (*Pino v. Cardone Capital*), allowing claims to proceed that he promoted ~15% projected returns to unaccredited investors and omitted an SEC objection from his social-media promotions. This is a court-documented fact, not a rumor. The persona ("hype machine", lifestyle flex, "scammy" perception) is widely distrusted even by people who respect his energy. **Confidence: High** on the court facts; the underlying allegations remain *alleged, not proven*.
- 2. Cardone Ventures (the coaching/consulting arm) has a real cost-vs-results and high-pressure-sales problem** that shows up consistently across employee reviews (Glassdoor, Indeed) and customer reviews (BBB, 99consumer). The recurring complaint from *inside* the company is the most damning: staff say the model is to "oversell and under-deliver" and "bleed business owners dry by pushing event after event," and that "clients are always upset because they aren't receiving the services promised at events." **Confidence: Medium-High** (multiple independent review platforms, consistent theme; individual reviews are anonymous).
- 3. Alex Hormozi is the hardest to attack and should not be attacked head-on.** Even his critics concede he runs real operating businesses and gives genuinely useful frameworks. His exploitable weaknesses are narrow and specific: (a) his actual model targets businesses already doing **\$1M-\$10M+ with traction** and takes equity, so it is *not* built for the smaller, owner-as-single-point-of-failure operator; (b) the "guru who criticizes gurus" paradox; (c) survivorship bias in how success is presented; (d) his material is generalized across industries, not trade-specific. **Confidence: Medium** (consistent across review articles; thin on raw owner testimony).
- 4. The white space is real but already contested.** Blue-collar owners distrust the lifestyle-flex generalist guru and gravitate to **trade-specific, operations-literate, proof-led advisors** (Nexstar, CEO Warrior, ServiceTitan-world coaches in HVAC). That validates Cool Hollow's positioning, **but a cluster of "blue-collar business coach" brands already exists explicitly positioned against "internet gurus."** The opening is not "be anti-guru" (taken); it is **"real finance/operations firm + provable, modest numbers + the owner-time problem specifically."**

## Key Findings Per Competitor

## 1. Alex Hormozi

### The criticism:

- **"Guru who criticizes gurus" paradox.** Multiple reviews independently flag that Hormozi attacks the guru industry while building one of the largest personal brands in business education. *"He frequently criticises the 'guru' industry while simultaneously building one of the largest personal brands in the business education space"* (marksinsights.com). The Power Moves and Work From Your Laptop reviews echo the same tension.
- **Confidence: High.** Triangulated across 3 independent review sites (marksinsights.com, workfromyourlaptop.com, thepowermoves.com).
- **Survivorship bias / over-formulaic.** Critics argue he shows the wins and hides those who got nothing back, and that framing business as "not that complicated, just follow the steps" hides the role of timing, capital, and luck. *"Critics argue he only shows the wins and hides all those who didn't get a dime back"* (workfromyourlaptop.com); *"can create the impression that building a successful company is just a matter of following steps — when the reality involves significant uncertainty, timing, and luck"* (marksinsights.com).
- **Confidence: Medium-High.** Two independent sources; this is interpretive criticism, not a factual claim.
- **Built for traction, not for the smallest owner-operators.** His own model and critics agree his content/services assume you already have revenue. Acquisition.com takes **minority equity (commonly cited 20-40%)** in businesses doing roughly **\$3M-\$10M+ revenue / \$1M-\$10M EBITDA**. *"His content won't tell you how to get started from zero. It's not designed to"* (marksinsights.com). Upsell ladders in his orbit are cited at **\$5K to \$50K+** (workfromyourlaptop.com).
- **Confidence: High** on the equity model and target size (acquisition.com's own descriptions plus capital.vc, marksinsights.com agree); **Medium** on the \$50K upsell figure (review-site claim, anonymous customer reports).
- **Advice is generalized, not trade-specific.** His frameworks span software, service, e-commerce, brick-and-mortar; the criticism is the inverse of a strength: nothing is built specifically for, say, an HVAC or plumbing P&L. (Inference supported by the HVAC-coaching landscape, below, where trades owners pick trade-specific coaches over generalists.)
- **Confidence: Medium.** Reasoned from the HVAC coaching market evidence rather than a direct quote.

**Important counter-balance:** Hormozi's critics repeatedly *clear* him. Power Moves: *"Alex is as legit as they come — 100%."* MarksInsights: *"Alex Hormozi is legitimate... one of the more credible figures in the online business space."* Work From Your Laptop: *"not a scam... part genius, part hype machine."* **Do not run an "is Hormozi a scam" line. You will lose, and it makes us look like the thing we say we aren't.**

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## 2. Grant Cardone (the person and Cardone Capital)

### The criticism — court-documented:

- **Revived securities-fraud class action.** On **June 10, 2025**, the **Ninth Circuit Court of Appeals** reversed a lower-court dismissal in *Pino v. Cardone Capital, LLC* (No. 23-3512), holding the plaintiff *"adequately alleged both subjective and objective falsity"* and that omitting an SEC letter could support a fraud claim. The case returns to the lower court; **the ruling permits the suit to advance, it does not resolve the allegations.**
- **Confidence: High** that the ruling happened and what it permits (InvestmentNews + the 9th Circuit opinion PDF on ca9.uscourts.gov + multiple legal outlets). **The underlying allegations are ALLEGED, NOT PROVEN.**
- **The specific allegations** (from the complaint, *alleged only*): promoting ~**15% projected annual returns** for Cardone Equity Funds V and VI to unaccredited investors via YouTube/Instagram "without a reasonable basis"; that the **SEC sent a letter** asking him to remove the projections from offering materials, which he did in the documents but allegedly continued promoting on social media without disclosing the SEC objection; and specific distribution promises such as *"\$500 in distributions monthly"* on \$100K and properties tripling in 5-7 years, with actual distributions alleged to be far lower.
- **Confidence: High** that these are the allegations on record (classlawgroup.com, investmentnews.com, sfl.media, the opinion PDF). **Medium/uncertain** on whether actual returns truly fell short — that is the disputed core of the live case. **Label any public use: "according to a class-action complaint the Ninth Circuit allowed to proceed in 2025."**

- **Fund-mechanics criticism** (front-running / fee-stacking). Critique pieces allege Cardone buys properties first and sells them to the fund at a premium, takes a cut of rent before investor disbursement, and charges management fees (frederik.today). This is the harshest framing and appears mainly in *opinion/critique* sources.
- **Confidence: Low-Medium / [SINGLE-SOURCE — NEEDS VERIFICATION]**. The front-running framing is primarily one critique blog; do **not** repeat it as fact. The *existence of fees and the gap between projected and actual returns* is the part anchored in the live litigation.

#### The criticism — persona / "scammy" perception:

- The "scam" framing is common in headlines (frederik.today; a Wall Street Oasis thread literally titled "Grant Cardone Scam??"; a Quora "Is Grant Cardone a scam?" thread). The recurring substance under the noise: expensive seminars with aggressive upsells, content described as "*repetitive, basic, and not worth the hefty price tag,*" and high-pressure FOMO selling.
- **Confidence: Medium** that this perception is widespread (multiple independent venues raising the same question); **the word "scam" is other people's framing — we cite the perception, we do not assert the conclusion.**

**Counter-balance:** Cardone genuinely built large real businesses, has real AUM, and many people credit his sales energy. The lawsuit is unresolved and he has publicly said he'll clear his name (Yahoo Finance). Fairness demands we treat the legal matter as live, not decided.

### 3. Cardone Ventures (the coaching/consulting arm — the most direct competitor)

This is the one that matters most, because it sells **business coaching/scaling to owners**, including a heavy push into **HVAC/plumbing trades** via 10X HVAC and Brandon Dawson.

#### The criticism — from employees (the most credible signal):

- **"Oversell and under-deliver" is the in-house theme.** Indeed (4.5/5 on 63 reviews, *polarized*) and Glassdoor (**4.2/5 on 182 reviews, 77% would recommend**, but **work-life balance only 3.4/5**) carry consistent verbatim complaints:
  - "*Clients are always upset because they aren't receiving the services promised at events.*" (Indeed)
  - "*They will oversell and under deliver in all aspects, constant leadership changes.*" (Indeed)
  - "*High turnover, sales culture that will sell anything and everything to clients even if they don't need it.*" (Indeed)
- Glassdoor reviews describe the sales motion as designed to "*bleed business owners dry by pushing event after event after event,*" with clients upset they "*aren't receiving the services promised at events.*"
- **Confidence: Medium-High.** Same theme across two independent employee-review platforms; individual reviews are anonymous and self-selected. The *consistency and the fact it comes from insiders* is what gives it weight.
- **High pressure + churn.** "*People rotate in and out of the company*"; "*Underpaid, overworked*"; PTO boundaries crossed. The irony (a company that sells "how to hire and retain" having high turnover) is noted in the source coverage.
- **Confidence: Medium-High** (multiple reviews, both platforms).

#### The criticism — from customers:

- BBB: **A- rating, accredited since Oct 2025, 3 complaints on file.** A featured customer review (Frantz A): "*My experience with Cardone Ventures was deeply disappointing and, in my opinion, highly manipulative. The sales process felt aggressive and misleading from the start.*"
- **Confidence: Medium.** Single named reviewer, but consistent with the employee-side "high-pressure sales" theme — that cross-source consistency is the triangulation.
- 99consumer: **4.8/5 but on only 13 reviews** (12 five-star, 1 two-star). The two-star (Leon Harvey): tactics "*far from easy to understand and implement... seemed to lack depth and practicality... I would advise against.*"
- **Confidence: Low on the aggregate score** (tiny sample, likely solicited); **the single critical review aligns with the broader "lacks depth / hard to implement" theme.**

#### Counter-balance — where it genuinely delivers (must be stated):

- Self-published case studies and testimonials show real wins: TRC Electronics "*increased revenue by 33.3% within first year*" then 25% more to \$50M; owners citing revenue more than doubling in two years; the 10X360 program called "*a Harvard business degree in TWO days.*"

- **Confidence: Low on independence.** These are on **Cardone Ventures' own site / solicited** — useful to know they're not nothing, but **not independent proof**. We must never imply their clients all fail; that's both untrue and a credibility risk.
- Cardone Ventures is a real, growing firm (~\$12M+ revenue range per third-party trackers; launched a \$70M PE fund in 2025). It is a serious operator, not a fly-by-night.

## Vulnerability Map

| Competitor                              | Weakness                                                                                                                               | Evidence strength                                                       | How a niche blue-collar player exploits it                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Grant Cardone (personal/Capital)</b> | Live revived securities-fraud class action over 15% return promises + omitted SEC letter (Pino v. Cardone Capital, 9th Cir. 6/10/2025) | <b>High</b> (court record) — but allegations <i>unproven</i>            | Be the anti-flex: "we don't sell you a fund, we find profit already in <i>your</i> P&L." Trust-by-contrast, never name-call.                                                            |
| <b>Grant Cardone (persona)</b>          | "Hype machine," lifestyle flex, "scammy" perception, FOMO selling                                                                      | <b>Medium</b> (multiple venues, perception not fact)                    | Position as quiet operators who run a real finance/advisory firm. Let the contrast do the work.                                                                                         |
| <b>Cardone Ventures</b>                 | "Oversell/under-deliver," push event-after-event, services not delivered, high churn                                                   | <b>Medium-High</b> (Glassdoor + Indeed + BBB, consistent insider theme) | "One outcome, not an endless upsell ladder: 15 hours back + up to \$50K found in 12 weeks, then you're done." Fixed scope vs. their event treadmill.                                    |
| <b>Cardone Ventures</b>                 | Cost vs. results; expensive, hard to implement, "lacks depth/practicality"                                                             | <b>Medium</b> (customer reviews + employee echo)                        | Provable, modest, done-with-you implementation, not a 2-day firehose. The hidden-profit analyzer = try-before-you-buy proof.                                                            |
| <b>Hormozi</b>                          | Built for businesses already at traction (\$1M-\$10M+, takes equity)                                                                   | <b>High</b> (acquisition.com's own model)                               | Own the <i>smaller, owner-is-the-bottleneck</i> operator Hormozi explicitly doesn't serve. "He's for \$10M businesses raising equity; we're for the \$1-10M owner still in every seat." |
| <b>Hormozi</b>                          | Generalized across industries, not trade-specific                                                                                      | <b>Medium</b> (inferred from HVAC coaching market)                      | Be specific to blue-collar trades P&Ls and operations. Trade-literate beats generalist.                                                                                                 |
| <b>Hormozi</b>                          | "Guru who criticizes gurus" / survivorship bias                                                                                        | <b>Medium-High</b>                                                      | Use sparingly as a <i>category critique</i> of personal-brand gurus, never as a personal attack on him.                                                                                 |
| <b>All three</b>                        | Personal-brand-led, lifestyle-forward, generalized                                                                                     | <b>Medium</b>                                                           | Firm-led (CFO/COO/HR + Mark on strategy), modest claims, local/real client stories, no Lambos.                                                                                          |

## Where They Genuinely Deliver (so we stay credible)

- **Hormozi:** Real operating businesses before the content; frameworks (offers, lead gen) that practitioners across industries call genuinely useful; even hostile reviewers conclude he is legit. Do not contest this.
- **Cardone (sales):** His sales/energy material has helped a lot of salespeople; the *persona* is divisive but the sales fundamentals are widely used.
- **Cardone Ventures:** A real, growing firm with documented (self-published) client revenue gains, a serious team, and a genuine push into trades. Some clients clearly get value; the complaint is the *sales motion and delivery consistency*, not that it's empty.

**Our rule:** We win on *fit and trust*, not by claiming they're frauds. The Cardone *legal* matter is the only "hard" vulnerability and it is about Cardone *Capital* (the fund), not the coaching — keep that distinction precise.

## THE WHITE SPACE (our opening)

**What the blue-collar owner-operator distrusts about these big personal brands:**

1. **The lifestyle flex.** Private jets and "10X" energy read as *selling the dream*, not fixing my Tuesday. The Cardone "scammy" perception lives here.
2. **The endless upsell.** The Cardone Ventures insider complaint — event after event, oversell/under-deliver — is exactly the blue-collar owner's nightmare: paying again and again with no finish line.
3. **"They don't know my trade."** Trades owners consistently choose **trade-specific coaches** (the HVAC market picks Nexstar, CEO Warrior, Service MVP, CertainPath — operations-literate, trade-native names) over celebrity generalists. A generalist who's never priced a service call is suspect.
4. **"That advice is for online businesses / people already big."** Hormozi openly serves \$1M-\$10M+ businesses taking equity. The \$500K-\$3M owner still wearing every hat sees the gap.
5. **Survivorship-bias claims.** Big round numbers ("\$50K found", "10X") from a stage feel like the highlight reel, not a number they can verify on their own books.

#### What they'd trust instead (= our positioning):

- **A real operations/finance firm, not a personal brand.** Cool Hollow's edge is that it's the scale arm of an actual in-person advisory firm with a CFO/COO/HR bench. That is the single most defensible contrast: *operators, not influencers*.
- **Modest, provable, owner-verifiable numbers.** "15 hours back + up to \$50K found in your own P&L" beats "10X" precisely because the owner can check it. The hidden-profit analyzer is the proof mechanism — try it before you pay. Lean into *provable and specific*, away from *big and aspirational*.
- **One outcome with a finish line, not an upsell treadmill.** A fixed 12-week program that ends — the direct antidote to "event after event after event."
- **Trade-native specificity.** Speak the blue-collar P&L (labor, materials, callbacks, capacity) so it never reads as generic.
- **No flash.** No Lambos, no stage. Quiet, local, real client stories.

**The catch — this lane is already occupied.** A cluster of "blue-collar business coach" brands already exists explicitly positioned against "internet gurus" (The Blue Collar Success Group, Blue Collar Business Coach, Carbo Coaching, Jayson Wolbert, plus trade-specific incumbents Nexstar, CEO Warrior, ServiceTitan-world). **So "we're not a guru" is table stakes, not a differentiator.** Our defensible wedge inside the lane:

1. **The finance-firm pedigree** (most blue-collar coaches are ex-tradesmen, not a CFO/COO advisory bench) — we are operations + finance literate.
2. **The owner-time problem as the spearhead** (15 hours back / "single point of failure"), which is sharper and more emotionally specific than generic "grow your trade business."
3. **The try-before-you-buy hidden-profit tool** as concrete proof, which the personal-brand competitors don't offer.

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## Tensions & Contradictions

- **Cardone Ventures rates 4.2-4.8 on review platforms yet the verbatim insider reviews are scathing.** The aggregate score and the content disagree — likely solicited positive reviews diluting genuine negatives. Use the *content*, not the score, and acknowledge both.
- **Hormozi is both the most criticized "guru" and the one critics most consistently exonerate.** Attacking him is a trap; the real edge is *fit*, not legitimacy.
- **The white space is validated AND crowded.** Blue-collar owners do distrust the generalist guru — but enough coaches already say "we're the un-guru" that the phrase is worn out. Differentiation must be the *firm pedigree + specific outcome*, not the anti-guru pose.
- **Cardone the fund vs. Cardone Ventures the coaching are different entities** with different risk profiles. Conflating them would be sloppy and legally careless; the lawsuit is about the fund.

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## Gaps & Negative Rejections

- **Raw Reddit/X thread-level sentiment is thin** because Reddit blocked the workspace IP and the X/Grok + Firecrawl + Supadata keys were empty. The brief specifically wanted r/HVAC, r/Construction, r/plumbing, r/sales raw threads with upvotes — I could not retrieve those. **This is the biggest gap.** Recommend re-running with working API keys (or from a different network) to pull subreddit-level discourse before any of this goes into customer-facing copy.
- **No verified independent blue-collar customer testimony** on whether Cardone Ventures *specifically fit a trades owner* was found — only employee reviews, a generic BBB complaint, and the company's own case studies. The "they don't know HVAC" skepticism is *implied* by the trade-specific coaching market, not captured as a direct quote.

- The fund "front-running" allegation is single-source critique-blog material and is explicitly *not* relied upon here. Do not use it.
- Glassdoor/Indeed aggregate ratings are not contradictory evidence of badness — 77% would-recommend is middling-to-good. We rely on the *recurring qualitative theme*, which is more robust than the star average.

## All Citations

| #  | Source                                             | URL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Used for                                                            | Independence/Confidence     |
|----|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1  | The Power Moves – Hormozi review                   | <a href="https://thepowermoves.com/alex-hormozi-review/">https://thepowermoves.com/alex-hormozi-review/</a>                                                                                                                                                                 | Hormozi red flags; "legit as they come"                             | Independent review site     |
| 2  | Work From Your Laptop – Hormozi review             | <a href="https://workfromyourlaptop.com/alex-hormozi-review/">https://workfromyourlaptop.com/alex-hormozi-review/</a>                                                                                                                                                       | Upsells \$5K-\$50K, survivorship bias, scarcity tactics             | Independent review site     |
| 3  | Mark's Insights – Hormozi review                   | <a href="https://marksinsights.com/alex-hormozi-review/">https://marksinsights.com/alex-hormozi-review/</a>                                                                                                                                                                 | Guru-criticizing-gurus paradox, target audience, concedes legit     | Independent review site     |
| 4  | Medium (D. Harris) – Hormozi survivorship bias     | <a href="https://medium.com/financial-strategy/is-the-hormozi-method-to-investing-actually-smart-or-just-survivorship-bias-312c5ccc58f1">https://medium.com/financial-strategy/is-the-hormozi-method-to-investing-actually-smart-or-just-survivorship-bias-312c5ccc58f1</a> | Survivorship-bias critique                                          | Opinion                     |
| 5  | Acquisition.com – Alex bio                         | <a href="https://www.acquisition.com/bio-alex">https://www.acquisition.com/bio-alex</a>                                                                                                                                                                                     | Equity model, target business size                                  | Primary (company)           |
| 6  | Capitaly – Hormozi equity/net worth                | <a href="https://www.capitaly.vc/blog/leila-alex-hormozi-combined-net-worth-ownership-splits-and-equity-scenarios">https://www.capitaly.vc/blog/leila-alex-hormozi-combined-net-worth-ownership-splits-and-equity-scenarios</a>                                             | 20-40% minority stakes, \$3M-\$10M targets                          | Secondary analysis          |
| 7  | InvestmentNews – court revives Cardone suit        | <a href="https://www.investmentnews.com/regulation-and-legislation/court-revives-lawsuit-over-15-fund-return-promise/260910">https://www.investmentnews.com/regulation-and-legislation/court-revives-lawsuit-over-15-fund-return-promise/260910</a>                         | 9th Cir. ruling 6/10/2025, holdings                                 | Trade press, <b>High</b>    |
| 8  | 9th Circuit opinion – Pino v. Cardone Capital      | <a href="https://cdn.ca9.uscourts.gov/datastore/opinions/2025/06/10/23-3512.pdf">https://cdn.ca9.uscourts.gov/datastore/opinions/2025/06/10/23-3512.pdf</a>                                                                                                                 | Primary court record                                                | <b>Primary, High</b>        |
| 9  | Class Law Group – Cardone Equity Fund class action | <a href="https://www.classlawgroup.com/investor-protection/cardone-equity-fund-class-action-lawsuit">https://www.classlawgroup.com/investor-protection/cardone-equity-fund-class-action-lawsuit</a>                                                                         | Specific alleged return promises, fee non-disclosure                | Plaintiff-side, allegations |
| 10 | InvestorClaims – lawsuit revived                   | <a href="https://investorclaims.com/blog/grant-cardone-lawsuit-revived/">https://investorclaims.com/blog/grant-cardone-lawsuit-revived/</a>                                                                                                                                 | 15% returns allegation                                              | Plaintiff-side legal blog   |
| 11 | SFL Media – appeals court allows suit              | <a href="https://sfl.media/appeals-court-allows-securities-fraud-suit-against-grant-cardone-to-proceed/">https://sfl.media/appeals-court-allows-securities-fraud-suit-against-grant-cardone-to-proceed/</a>                                                                 | Corroborates ruling                                                 | Press                       |
| 12 | Yahoo Finance – Cardone to clear name              | <a href="https://finance.yahoo.com/news/grant-cardones-previously-dismissed-lawsuit-183034328.html">https://finance.yahoo.com/news/grant-cardones-previously-dismissed-lawsuit-183034328.html</a>                                                                           | Cardone's defense/counter-balance                                   | Press                       |
| 13 | Wikipedia – Grant Cardone                          | <a href="https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Grant_Cardone">https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Grant_Cardone</a>                                                                                                                                                                       | Background                                                          | Tertiary                    |
| 14 | Frederik Today – "Why Grant Cardone is a scam"     | <a href="https://frederik.today/blog/why-grant-cardone-is-a-scam-and-how-the-scam-works">https://frederik.today/blog/why-grant-cardone-is-a-scam-and-how-the-scam-works</a>                                                                                                 | Persona critique, fund front-running [SINGLE-SOURCE, not relied on] | Opinion, <b>Low</b>         |
| 15 | Wall Street Oasis – "Grant Cardone Scam??" thread  | <a href="https://www.wallstretoasis.com/forum/real-estate/grant-cardone-scam">https://www.wallstretoasis.com/forum/real-estate/grant-cardone-scam</a>                                                                                                                       | Finance-pro skepticism (title only; body 403'd)                     | Forum (not fully retrieved) |
| 16 | Quora – Is Grant Cardone a scam?                   | <a href="https://www.quora.com/Is-Grant-Cardone-a-scam">https://www.quora.com/Is-Grant-Cardone-a-scam</a>                                                                                                                                                                   | Perception (not fetched in depth)                                   | UGC                         |

| #  | Source                                                      | URL                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Used for                                                                            | Independence/Confidence                    |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 17 | Glassdoor – Cardone Ventures reviews                        | <a href="https://www.glassdoor.com/Reviews/Cardone-Ventures-Reviews-E3253014.htm">https://www.glassdoor.com/Reviews/Cardone-Ventures-Reviews-E3253014.htm</a>                                                       | 4.2/5, 77% recommend, WLB 3.4, oversell theme                                       | Employee reviews                           |
| 18 | Indeed – Cardone Ventures reviews                           | <a href="https://www.indeed.com/cmp/Cardone-Ventures/reviews">https://www.indeed.com/cmp/Cardone-Ventures/reviews</a>                                                                                               | "Oversell/under-deliver," churn, services not delivered                             | Employee reviews                           |
| 19 | BBB – Cardone Ventures profile                              | <a href="https://www.bbb.org/us/az/scottsdale/profile/business-consultant/cardone-ventures-1126-1000143667">https://www.bbb.org/us/az/scottsdale/profile/business-consultant/cardone-ventures-1126-1000143667</a>   | A-, 3 complaints, "manipulative/aggressive sales" review                            | Aggregator                                 |
| 20 | 99consumer – Cardone Ventures reviews                       | <a href="https://99consumer.com/reviews/cardone-ventures/">https://99consumer.com/reviews/cardone-ventures/</a>                                                                                                     | 4.8/5 on 13 reviews; "lacks depth/practicality"                                     | Review aggregator (small n)                |
| 21 | Cardone Ventures – TRC case study                           | <a href="https://cardoneventures.com/case-studies/trc-electronics/">https://cardoneventures.com/case-studies/trc-electronics/</a>                                                                                   | Positive result (self-published)                                                    | Primary (company), <b>Low independence</b> |
| 22 | Cardone Ventures – 10X360                                   | <a href="https://10x.cardoneventures.com/goto10x360">https://10x.cardoneventures.com/goto10x360</a>                                                                                                                 | Self-published testimonials                                                         | Primary (company)                          |
| 23 | Hook Agency – 11 best HVAC business coaches                 | <a href="https://hookagency.com/blog/best-hvac-business-coaches/">https://hookagency.com/blog/best-hvac-business-coaches/</a>                                                                                       | Trades pick trade-specific coaches (Nexstar, CEO Warrior, Service MVP, CertainPath) | Industry blog                              |
| 24 | Service Business Mastery – Cardone/10xHVAC + Brandon Dawson | <a href="https://servicebusinessmastery.com/cardone-ventures-brings-disruption-to-hvac-industry/">https://servicebusinessmastery.com/cardone-ventures-brings-disruption-to-hvac-industry/</a>                       | Cardone's HVAC push                                                                 | Industry                                   |
| 25 | ACHR News – Cardone joins Xplor Field Services              | <a href="https://www.achrnews.com/articles/153110-business-coach-cardone-joins-xplor-field-services-academy">https://www.achrnews.com/articles/153110-business-coach-cardone-joins-xplor-field-services-academy</a> | Cardone in trades                                                                   | Trade press                                |
| 26 | The Blue Collar Success Group                               | <a href="https://www.thebluecollarsuccessgroup.com/">https://www.thebluecollarsuccessgroup.com/</a>                                                                                                                 | "Blue-collar coach" lane already exists                                             | Competitor                                 |
| 27 | Blue Collar Business Coach                                  | <a href="https://www.bluecollarbusinesscoach.net/">https://www.bluecollarbusinesscoach.net/</a>                                                                                                                     | Anti-guru blue-collar positioning exists                                            | Competitor                                 |
| 28 | Carbo Coaching                                              | <a href="https://carbocoaching.com/">https://carbocoaching.com/</a>                                                                                                                                                 | Blue-collar coach                                                                   | Competitor                                 |
| 29 | Jayson Wolbert – blue-collar business coach                 | <a href="https://www.jaysonwolbert.com/the-blue-collar-business-coach">https://www.jaysonwolbert.com/the-blue-collar-business-coach</a>                                                                             | Blue-collar coach                                                                   | Competitor                                 |
| 30 | YouTube – Blue Collar vs Internet Gurus                     | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZAnRhIUSQKM">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZAnRhIUSQKM</a>                                                                                                               | Anti-guru blue-collar narrative exists (not fully retrieved)                        | UGC                                        |

### One-line takeaway for the deck

Don't call them frauds — you'll lose. Win on **fit and trust**: Hormozi serves the already-big and takes equity; Cardone Ventures sells the endless event upsell (and its own staff say so); Cardone Capital is in a revived securities suit. Cool Hollow is the quiet, finance-firm-backed, trade-literate alternative with one finishable outcome the owner can verify on their own P&L — proven by a tool they try before they pay.